



has been organising the Corporate Citizenship Challenge for the Cause of Children, or 5Cs. 5Cs started life with NGO CRY. Initially, it was only a cricket tournament, but now it encompasses several sports and the NGO partner is Concern India Foundation. Between 15 and 20 corporates take part in 5Cs every year. Jaswinder personally patronises this tournament.

Jaswinder says, “My involvement, obviously, with the startups in the ESDM ecosystem is another way for me to be able to give back to society. I would like to stay very actively involved in education, in the cause of children, and in encouraging and mentoring youngsters and young startups.” Jaswinder has been directly and indirectly involved with many startups, both through the Electropreneur Park under STPI as well as outside.

Enjoying life beyond work

Jaswinder began his family life simultaneously with his professional



Jaswinder Ahuja participating in a half Marathon



Jaswinder Ahuja at the inauguration of Vidya & Child School in Noida that Cadence partners

journey. He met his wife Anuradha as his batchmate at IIT-BHU. They got married two years after completing the engineering degree. She worked in various important technical positions in Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL), CMC, and Hughes Software Systems, and even did a startup. He considers her a pillar of strength in his life and a great support.

Jaswinder and Anuradha have two daughters, Simran and Mansi. Their elder daughter Simran is working as a Business Systems Analyst and the younger one Mansi is still in college pursuing Law. While sharing a few memorable family moments, Jaswinder narrates, “At this stage of life, I want to devote my quality time with my daughters. I make it mandatory for myself to take ten days of annual vacation every year and spend time with my family. I love trying out new things with my daughters so that I can encourage them to be experimental and take on new challenges. We did scuba diving together in the Great Barrier Reef. It was one of the wishes on my bucket list which I was

able to achieve.”

In addition to living a happy family life, Jaswinder continues nurturing his passion for sports, music, and food. He participates in the half Marathon regularly. As a food connoisseur, he loves to try authentic local food whenever and wherever he travels. However, he has a special soft corner for Awadhi cuisine. He loves listening to Gazals, old Hindi film songs from the 60s and 70s, as well as Jazz. While his all-time favourites in Indian singers are the two legends Farida Khanum and Mohd Rafi, he is also quite fond of the jazz idol Frank Sinatra.

Reflection is a daily ritual for Jaswinder. He prefers to reflect and spend time with himself during his morning walk. He describes, “Honestly, that is my most valuable time to reflect, to think, to plan. I mean, it's the most productive time of the day. For me, reflection is the most powerful tool for learning from my own experiences, to begin with. And then, obviously, for planning for the day, the week, the month ahead, and for identifying the areas of my focus.” **EFY**